PATASPACE ACADEMY

Terms of Service & Student Agreement

The Official Agreement Between PataSpace Academy and Every Enrolled Student

Version 1.0 | Effective: April 27, 2026

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1. Introduction

Welcome to PataSpace Academy. By enrolling in any PataSpace Academy program, cohort, or mentorship track, you (the Student) agree to be bound by these Terms of Service.

Please read this document carefully. It protects both you and the Academy, and ensures everyone operates with the same expectations.

PataSpace Academy is operated by Sammy Kiprop (hereinafter referred to as the Academy) based in Kutus, Kirinyaga County, Kenya.

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2. Enrollment & Eligibility

2.1 Who May Enroll

PataSpace Academy programs are open to any individual who:

- Is 16 years of age or older
- Has access to a personal laptop or desktop computer
- Has reliable internet access for online sessions
- Has completed and submitted the Student Information Form
- Has paid the commitment fee prior to the cohort start date

2.2 Enrollment Confirmation

Enrollment is only confirmed upon:

1. Submission of the completed Student Information Form

2. Payment of the Commitment Fee (KES 500)
3. Receipt of a confirmation message from the Academy

Completing the form without payment does NOT constitute enrollment. The Academy reserves the right to decline enrollment at its sole discretion.

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3. Fees & Payment

3.1 Fee Structure

Fee Type	Amount (KES)	Notes
Commitment Fee	500	Non-refundable. Applied to Month 1 fee.
Monthly Tuition	500	Due on the 1st of every month
Late Payment Fee	100	Applied after 7-day grace period
Re-enrollment Fee	300	For students re-joining after dropping out

3.2 Payment Method

All fees are payable via M-Pesa to the Academy's official Till/Paybill number. Bank transfers and cash payments are accepted only with prior written approval from the Lead Mentor.

3.3 Late Payment

If monthly tuition is not received within 7 days of the due date:

- A late fee of KES 100 is added
- Access to session materials may be restricted
- After 14 days of non-payment, the student's enrollment may be suspended

3.4 Refund Policy

The following refund policy applies:

- Commitment Fee: Non-refundable under all circumstances
- Monthly Tuition: Refundable (50%) if withdrawal is communicated before the 10th of the month
- Monthly Tuition: Non-refundable after the 10th of the month

- Special circumstances (medical, family emergency) may be considered by the Lead Mentor at their discretion

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4. Program Structure & Student Responsibilities

4.1 Attendance

Students are expected to attend a minimum of 75% of all scheduled sessions per month. Attendance below this threshold without prior communication will result in a formal check-in with the Lead Mentor.

To notify of absence, the student must:

- Message the cohort WhatsApp group at least 2 hours before the session
- Catch up on missed content independently via shared session notes
- Complete any tasks assigned during the missed session before the next one

4.2 Assignment Submissions (Pull Requests)

PataSpace Academy uses GitHub Pull Requests as the primary submission method for all tasks. Students agree to:

- Submit original work only — copying code without understanding is a violation
- Submit PR links before the stated deadline for each task
- Respond to mentor code review feedback within 72 hours
- Not merge their own PRs without mentor approval

4.3 Academic Integrity

The following constitute violations of academic integrity:

- Submitting AI-generated code as your own without disclosure
- Copying another student's code and submitting as your own
- Asking someone else to complete your task on your behalf

First violation: Written warning and task resubmission required.

Second violation: Suspension from the cohort for 2 weeks.

Third violation: Permanent removal from PataSpace Academy without refund.

NOTE: Using AI tools (GitHub Copilot, Claude) as a learning aid is permitted and encouraged. The violation is submitting AI output without understanding it.

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5. Code of Conduct

PataSpace Academy is a professional engineering environment. All students agree to the following:

5.1 Respect

- Treat all fellow students, mentors and instructors with respect
- No harassment, discrimination, or hate speech of any kind
- Critique code, never character

5.2 Professionalism

- Arrive on time for sessions
- Communicate proactively — if you are struggling, say so early
- Keep the cohort WhatsApp group professional — no spam or off-topic content

5.3 Constructive Participation

- Participate actively in code reviews — reviewing others' code accelerates your learning
- Ask questions openly — there are no stupid questions in this environment
- Share resources and knowledge freely with your cohort

5.4 Violation Consequences

Level	Violation Type	Consequence
Level 1	Minor (lateness, spam)	Verbal warning from Lead Mentor
Level 2	Repeated or moderate	Written warning, formal meeting
Level 3	Serious misconduct	2-week suspension
Level 4	Harassment or fraud	Permanent removal, no refund

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6. Intellectual Property

6.1 Student Work

All code written by students during the program belongs to the student. PataSpace Academy does not claim ownership of any project, application, or repository created by students during or after the program.

6.2 Academy Materials

All curriculum materials, session notes, slide decks, video recordings, and written resources provided by PataSpace Academy are the intellectual property of the Academy. Students may not:

- Share or distribute Academy materials outside the cohort
- Sell or commercialize Academy materials
- Reproduce Academy curriculum for their own teaching without written permission

6.3 Portfolio Rights

Students are encouraged and permitted to showcase their Academy projects in their personal portfolio, GitHub profile, and job applications. PataSpace Academy may also showcase student work (with student consent) for Academy marketing purposes.

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7. Privacy & Data

PataSpace Academy collects the following student information: name, phone number, email, GitHub username, and academic background. This information is used solely for:

- Communication regarding sessions and Academy updates
- Payment processing
- Progress tracking and mentor assignment

Student data is never sold to third parties. Student information is stored securely and accessible only to Academy staff.

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8. Certificates & Completion

Students who complete all modules in their track, submit all PR tasks, and pass the final Boss Battle project will receive a PataSpace Academy Completion Certificate.

The certificate will state:

- Student full name
- Track completed (C# Backend or JavaScript/Frontend)
- Cohort number and completion date
- Signed by the Lead Mentor

A certificate is not issued to students who: drop out and re-enroll mid-track, have outstanding payment dues at completion, or are removed for code of conduct violations.

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9. Amendments

PataSpace Academy reserves the right to update these Terms of Service at any time. Students will be notified of material changes via the cohort WhatsApp group with at least 7 days notice. Continued enrollment after the effective date of changes constitutes acceptance.

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10. Student Agreement Signature

By enrolling in PataSpace Academy and paying the commitment fee, I confirm that:

- I have read and understood these Terms of Service
- I agree to abide by the Code of Conduct
- I understand the fee structure and refund policy
- I commit to attending sessions, submitting PRs, and engaging seriously

Student Full Name: _____	**Date:** _____
Student Signature: _____	**Lead Mentor Signature:** _____